

PM launches ₹1 trillion scheme to boost R&D and innovation

PM Narendra Modi announced the ₹1 trillion Research, Development, and Innovation Scheme at the Emerging Science, Technology, and Innovation Conclave (ESTIC) 2025, held in New Delhi from November 3 to 6, 2025. The scheme aims to foster a private sector-driven R&D ecosystem and strengthen India's innovation and technological capabilities.



PM Narendra Modi inaugurates the ESTIC 2025 at Bharat Mandapam, in New Delhi on November 03, 2025 (Credit: www.pib.gov.in)

Government to triple incentives for rare earth magnets worth ₹70 billion

The Indian government is reportedly planning to nearly triple the size of its incentive programme for rare earth magnet manufacturing to over ₹70 billion (\$788 million), in a bid to boost domestic capacity in

a sector long dominated by China. The initiative aligns with India's broader strategy to reduce its reliance on China, which processes nearly 90% of the world's rare earth output.

PEOPLE (on the move)

DRDO appoints Dr M. Raghavendra Rao as the new Director at ASL Hyderabad



Dr M. Raghavendra Rao, a senior scientist at the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and an expert in missile propulsion, has been appointed Director of the Advanced Systems Laboratory (ASL) in Hyderabad. A PhD from NIT Warangal, he previously led key propulsion projects for Agni, naval, and hypersonic systems. ASL, part of DRDO's APJ Abdul Kalam Missile Complex, drives India's missile development programmes.

Panasonic's Manish Sharma bids farewell after 17 years

Panasonic Life Solutions India chairman and ESGO, Manish Sharma, is stepping down after 17 years, marking the close

of a transformative tenure. He played a key role in local expansion, innovation initiatives, and industry advocacy. The company said he will support transition efforts while newer leadership drives future growth. There has been no disclosure about his future steps.

Tesla appoints ex-Lamborghini head Sharad Agarwal to lead India operations



Tesla has appointed Sharad Agarwal, formerly head of Lamborghini India, to lead its operations in India. He will oversee the automaker's push in the country, signalling a shift from its previous regional-reporting structure. His luxury-auto background suggests Tesla may prioritise aspirational consumers before broad mass-market expansion.

